

Moritz Wiedemann

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

ROTTERDAM SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT, ERASMUS UNIVERSITY, Assistant Professor of Finance 2024 -

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

FUTUREPROOFING INSTITUTE, Head of Research 2026 -
CORNELL UNIVERSITY, Visiting Researcher 2024 - 2025

EDUCATION

IMPERIAL COLLEGE LONDON, PhD in Finance 2019 - 2024
CORNELL UNIVERSITY, Visiting PhD Student 2022
IMPERIAL COLLEGE LONDON, MRes - Finance Pathway (Distinction) 2018 - 2019
ERASMUS UNIVERSITY ROTTERDAM, MSc Finance & Investments Advanced (Cum Laude) 2016 - 2018
ERASMUS UNIVERSITY ROTTERDAM, BSc Intl. Business Administration (Summa Cum Laude) 2013 - 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Sustainable Finance, Health & Finance

PUBLICATIONS

Opiod Crisis and Real Estate Prices

WITH CLÁUDIA CUSTÓDIO AND DRAGANA CVIJANOVIĆ

Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis. 2026; 61(4):1604-1631.

We study the impact of opioid abuse on real estate prices. We document that opioid death rates and excess prescription rates are negatively associated with house prices. Exploiting the staggered passage of opioid-limiting legislation, we find that a decrease in opioid abuse results in higher county-level house prices. This effect is due to fewer mortgage delinquencies, lower vacancy rates, more home improvement loans, and increased population inflow. Our findings are consistent with improved real estate conditions and a rise in local demand. These results highlight the importance of public health policy in mitigating the economic costs of the opioid epidemic.

WORKING PAPERS

The CO2 Question: Technical Progress and the Climate Crisis

WITH PATRICK BOLTON AND MARCIN KACPERCZYK

REVISE & RESUBMIT AT JOURNAL OF FINANCE

We split environmental innovation into pure green and fuel-efficiency patent categories and study their relation to corporate carbon emissions in a global sample of firms. Green innovation is mostly unrelated to direct or indirect emissions, whereas fuel-efficiency innovation predicts lower emission intensity, with gains concentrated in emission-intensive industries—a result that survives instrumenting with quasi-random patent-examiner assignment. Intensity gains do not translate into lower total emissions: fuel-efficiency innovation also predicts higher sales and capital expenditure, consistent with a Jevons-type rebound. Fuel-efficiency innovation diffuses through production networks to non-innovating firms; green innovation displays patterns consistent with cross-industry displacement.

Futureproofing companies & valuation ratios

WITH WANDER MARIJNISSEN, DIRK SCHOENMAKER, AND WILLEM SCHRAMADE

REVISE & RESUBMIT AT INTERNATIONAL REVIEW OF FINANCIAL ANALYSIS

Companies face serious transition risks and opportunities, which are not well captured by current valuation ratios. The solution lies in expanding valuation ratios with externalities (external impacts), which are good proxies for transition risks and opportunities. Building on impact valuation methods, we model a company's integrated value, which combines financial, social and environmental value. We then turn integrated value into a valuation ratio: the futureproofing ratio, which is a natural next step beyond the price-to-book ratio. As an illustration of use, we quantify the futureproofing ratios of 23 companies on the Amsterdam Stock Exchange. These estimates suggest that the futureproofing ratio varies significantly across companies and sectors, and that it provides valuable insight in the transition risk of a company's business model. The futureproofing ratio can be applied by company management and investors, as a guide for assessment and decision making.

Do Responsible Institutional Investors Drive Green Capital Expenditures? Evidence from Cross-Listings

This paper examines whether responsible institutional ownership affects firms' green capital expenditures. Exploiting regional differences in sustainability preferences, I use U.S. cross-listings by European and Asian firms as plausibly exogenous negative shocks to responsible ownership. In a staggered difference-in-differences design, cross-listed firms experience a shift toward U.S. institutional ownership, a decline in responsible ownership, and lower subsequent green debt issuance. Complementary evidence links greater responsible ownership to more green patenting and lower greenhouse gas emissions. Together, the findings suggest that responsible investors shape firms' green capital expenditures and environmental outcomes rather than merely engaging in cheap talk.

Nature Dependence, Economic Value, and Extinction Risk: Evidence from Biotech Innovations

WITH ADRIAN LAM AND MARCIN DAVID LICHER

This paper examines how nature dependence translates into economic value in the context of biotech innovations. We identify biotech patents as those involving the application of science to living organisms, and document that biotech patenting activities span across industries. Our most conservative estimate indicates that biotech patents are \$639,000 more valuable than other granted patents, which is also reflected in firm level valuation and cash flow metrics. Exploiting a shock to the recognition of extinction risk of species in a patent, we show that constrained firms have lower valuation, cash flows, and capital expenditures. Overall, our results suggest that while nature dependence via biotechnology is valuable, the recognition of extinction risk can have significant implications for firm value.

Childhood Mental Health and Long Run Financial Outcomes

WITH DRAGANA CVIJANOVIĆ AND ATLAS WU

This paper examines how childhood mental health conditions shape financial outcomes later in life. Using 1996–2020 Health and Retirement Study data, we build a household-level financial fragility index and find that households with childhood mental health conditions have weaker adult balance sheets, including fewer financial assets, lower risky-asset participation and homeownership, and more non-mortgage debt. These balance-sheet patterns are accompanied by more pessimistic expectations and shorter financial planning horizons, consistent with financial behavior as an important channel. Our results are mirrored when using a polygenic score for major depressive disorder as a predetermined measure of mental health conditions.

TEACHING

Rotterdam School of Management, EUR

Corporate Finance I, MSc

2025 - 2026

Financial Decision Making, BSc

2025 - 2026

INVITED AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026** MFA*, Eastern Finance Association*, 1st Transatlantic Workshop in Energy and Nature Finance, World Biodiversity Forum, Dutch Sustainable Finance Workshop, CINCH Economics of Mental Health Workshop, RBFC
- 2025** Conference on the Economics and Finance of Healthcare and Medicine at WashU*, Workshop on Biodiversity and Finance at Imperial, German Finance Association
- 2024** AFA, Adam Smith Sustainability Conference, GRASFI, Entrepreneurship and Innovation Symposium NOVA
- 2023** UBC Winter Finance Conference, SSE Harnessing Finance for Climate*, Carey Finance Conference PhD Session, Hoyt Institute*
- 2022** CEPR Advanced Forum for Financial Economics (CAFFE)*, UBC Sauder Business School*, University of Southern California*, Bocconi University*, Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics*, ECB Conference on Money Markets*
- 2021** AREUEA 2021 National Conference, MIT CRE Seminar Series*, Baruch College*, Ted Rodgers School of Business Management - Ryerson*
- 2020** UZH Young Researcher Workshop on Climate Finance, University of Reading*
- 2019** GRASFI Phd Workshop; University of Siegen Conference on Risk Governance and Sustainability
- (*: conference presentation by co-author)

AWARDS AND PRIZES

- PhD President's Scholarship, Imperial College London 2019
- Business School MRes Scholarship, Imperial College London 2018
- Academic Excellence Scholarship, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2016

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Discussions

- Beyond lockdowns: Working from home and mental health across three phases of the pandemic 2026
By Anam Bilgrami.
Economics of Mental Health Workshop 2026
- Climate Policy and Firm Efficiency: Lessons From the Trucking Industry 2025
By Gustav Martinsson, Per Strömberg, and Christian Thomann.
52nd EFA Annual Meeting
- ESG Skill of Mutual Fund Managers 2025
By Marco Ceccarelli, Richard B. Evans, Simon Glossner, Mikael Homanen, and Ellie Luu.
2025 MFA Annual Meeting
- Green Products 2025
By Wan-chien Chiu, Po-hsuan Hsu, Kai Li, and Joy Tianjiao Tong.
2025 AFA Annual Meeting
- Smart Cities: Digital Solutions to a Green Future 2024
By Xiaoqing (Maggie) Fu, Endong Yang, and Hongli Jiang.
Adam Smith Sustainability Conference & 2nd Annual Conference of the British Accounting Review
- Financing the Global Shift to Electric Mobility 2024
By Jan Bena, Bo Bian, and Huan Tang.
51st EFA Annual Meeting

Climate Innovation and Carbon Emissions: Evidence from Supply Chain Networks 2023
 By Ulrich Hege, Kai Li, and Yifei Zhang.
1st HEC - HKUST Workshop on Impact and Sustainable Finance

Climate risk and financial stability in the network of banks and investment funds 2020
 By Alan Roncoroni, Stefano Battiston, Luis Onésimo Leonardo Escobar Farfán, and Serafin Martinez Jaramillo.
UZH Young Researcher Workshop on Climate Finance

Refereeing Activities

Journal of Corporate Finance; Journal of Empirical Finance; Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money; Management Science; Review of Corporate Finance Studies; Review Of Economic Studies; Review of Finance; Review of Financial Studies

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Professor Patrick Bolton	2021-2024
Professor Gilles Chemla	2018-2021
Professor David Miles	2019-2020

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Associate Consultant (intern), zeb.rolfes.schierenbeck.associates GmbH – Consulting	2017
Analyst (intern), Krombacher Brauerei GmbH & Co. KG – Brewery	2016
Junior Valuation (intern), Commerzbank AG – Investment Banking	2015
Assistant of the Head of Finance (intern), Biesterfeld Plastics GmbH – Polymer Distrib.	2014

OTHER

SOFTWARE	LaTex, Python, R, Stata
LANGUAGES	German (native), English (fluent), French (elementary), Dutch (elementary)

REFERENCES

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 Imperial College Business School
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 Emory University
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